

# THE BLACK PANTHER

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ALDERMAN LIBRARY

FEB 24 1977

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# 1,500 RALLY TO FREE A.I.M. ACTIVISTS



Black Panther Party chairperson ELAINE BROWN and American Indian Movement leader DENNIS BANKS were featured speakers at last week's march and rally to free Native American political prisoners.

(Sacramento, Calif.) - In what was one of the largest demonstrations in memory to support Native American rights, close to 1,500 people assembled here last week to participate in a spirited and moving march and rally demanding the release of American Indian Movement (AIM) activists imprisoned throughout the United States.

In particular, the demonstration focused on the case of Paul Skyhorse and Richard Mohawk, two AIM leaders falsely accused of murder in racist Ventura County. Related demands put forth at the rally included:

- Stop all FBI and repressive attacks on Indian people; and
- Support self-determination, sovereignty and independence for Indian Nations.

Also, organizers of the demonstration announced that they are going to begin a major drive to petition President Carter to establish a National Indian Judicial Review Committee to review the cases of many Native American people victimized by the American courts, and to grant pardons for those unjustly incarcerated.

Featured speakers at the rally, held in the Capitol Mall under warm and sunny skies, were Elaine Brown, chairperson of the Black Panther Party; Dennis Banks, national AIM leader and presently an instructor at D-Q University in Davis, California; Lehman Brightman, president of United Native Americans; and Ken Littlefish, an AIM leader from the Los Angeles area.

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